

Event & Community Description (parkrun Application)

Proposed Event Name: Johnson Park parkrun (serving New Brunswick & Piscataway)

Description About Myself: Alex Patelski, Division One Athlete Intern For IDEA

Rutgers → London

- Rutgers Global Presence
- Rutgers UK Board
- Running Culture in the US to Running Culture in London

About the Community & Why We Want to Bring parkrun Here:

New Brunswick and Piscataway sit at a crossroads between diverse residential communities, working families, hospital healthcare workers, and a vibrant college population. At this crossroads, thousands of people cross paths each day. This is why we want to bring parkrun to Johnson Park to create a shared, permanent Saturday morning ritual where all of these groups can connect naturally.

Bringing parkrun here gives our area a free anchor where one can center on wellness, friendship, and mutual encouragement rather than finish times.

Course Atmosphere & Accessibility:

Johnson Park is an easily accessible path directly along the Raritan River. The proposed course uses wide, smooth, paved multi-use paths that wind under tree canopies with uninterrupted water views.

- **Inclusive & Flat:** The terrain is completely flat, making it accessible for walkers, parents with jogging strollers, and participants of varied mobility.
- **Essential Amenities:** The park is easily accessible from both sides of the river, featuring abundant free parking lots and permanent public restrooms right near our envisioned start/finish area.

The Social Element & Post-Event Vision:

parkrun isn't just about the 5K; it's about what happens afterward. We want to carry the spirit of the event into our local neighborhood by establishing a regular post-run café meet-up nearby. This will be a place where runners and volunteers sit down together over coffee to chat, sort finish tokens, and build real community relationships across student and local resident lines.

Volunteer & Team Foundation:

Our leadership circle is building an energetic, multi-generational volunteer base. By tapping into local running enthusiasts (such as the Raritan Valley Road Runners and campus run clubs) alongside dedicated student service groups and local neighbors, we are establishing a sustainable, rotating team. This ensures our event has deep roots, consistent coverage, and an uplifting, inclusive atmosphere from day one.